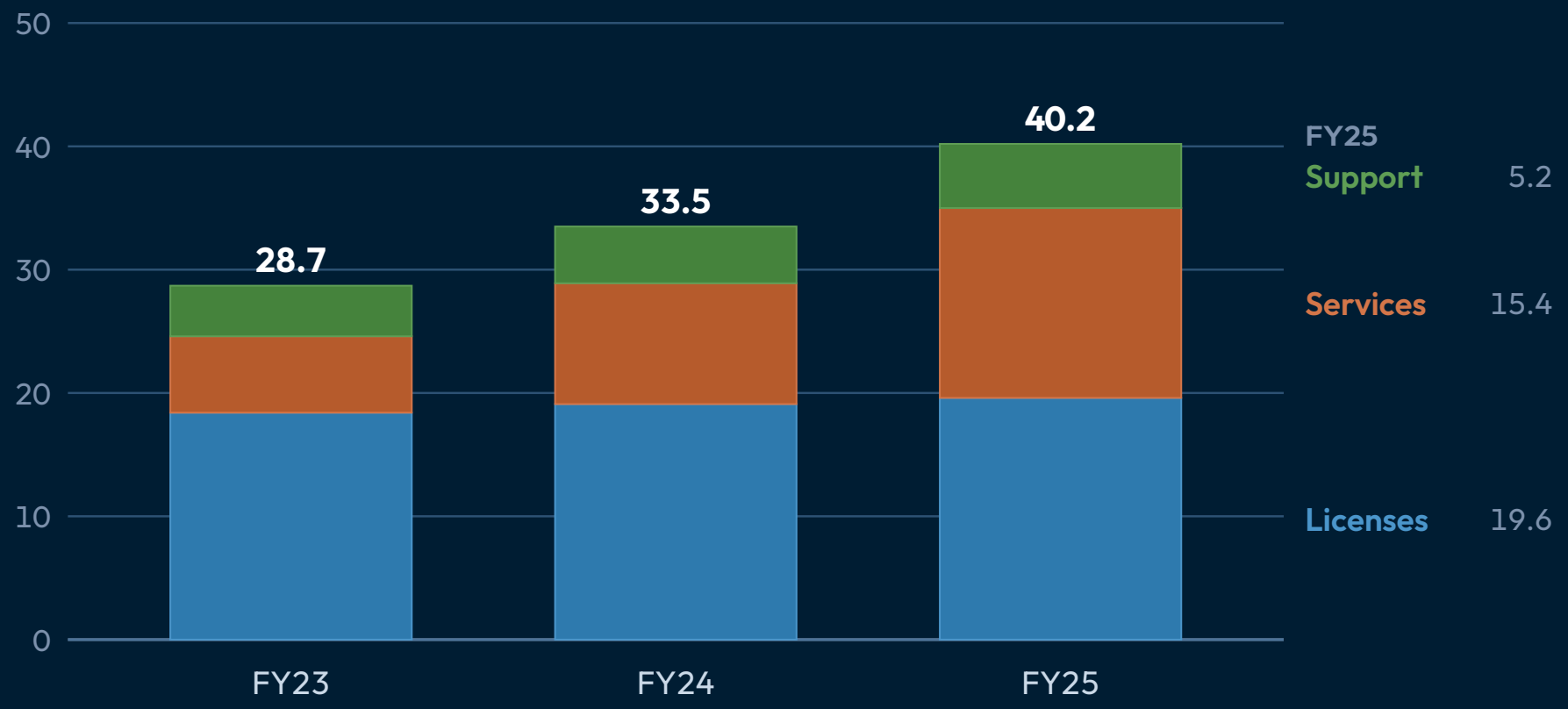
Evidence · Canvas · Series

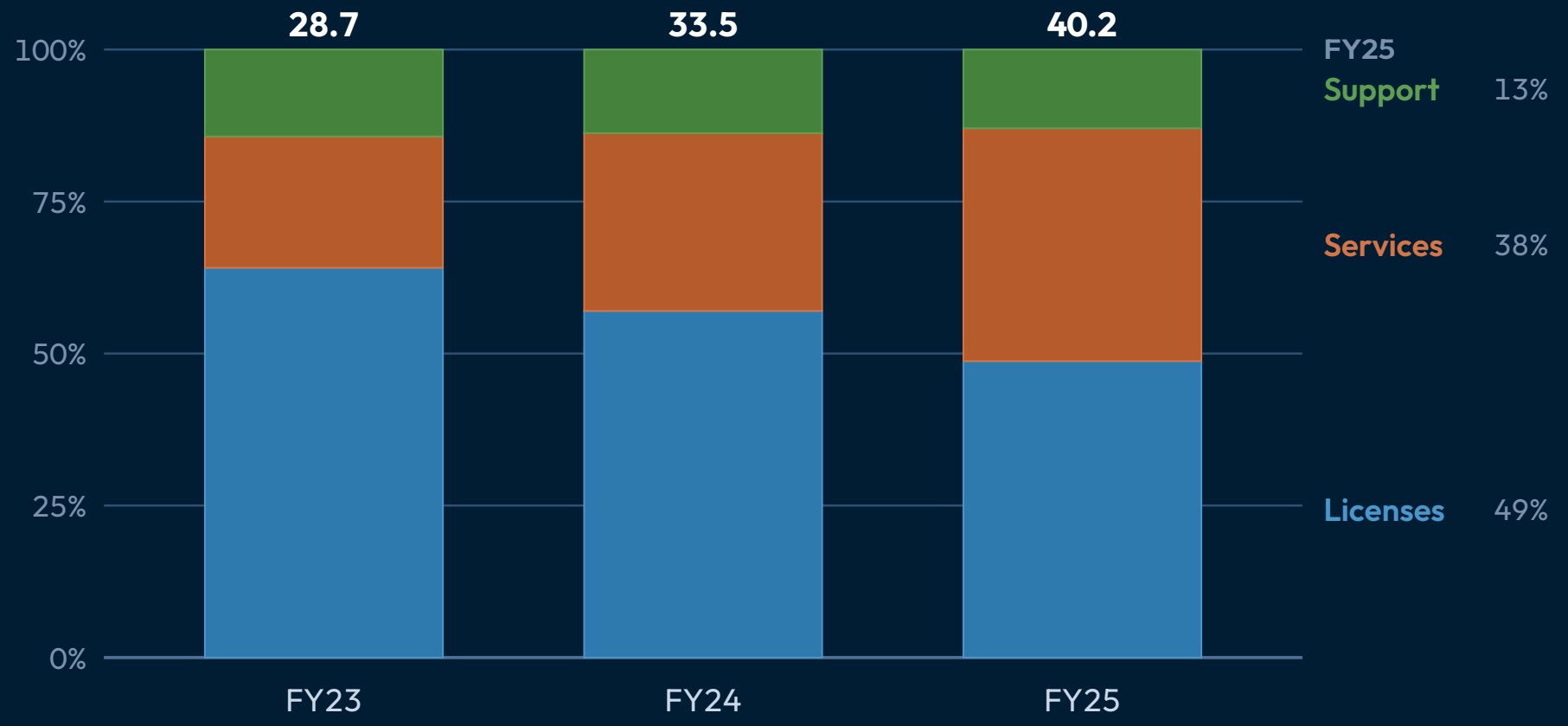
stacked-bar

Bars split into parts, so one chart carries both the total for each category and the mix inside it.

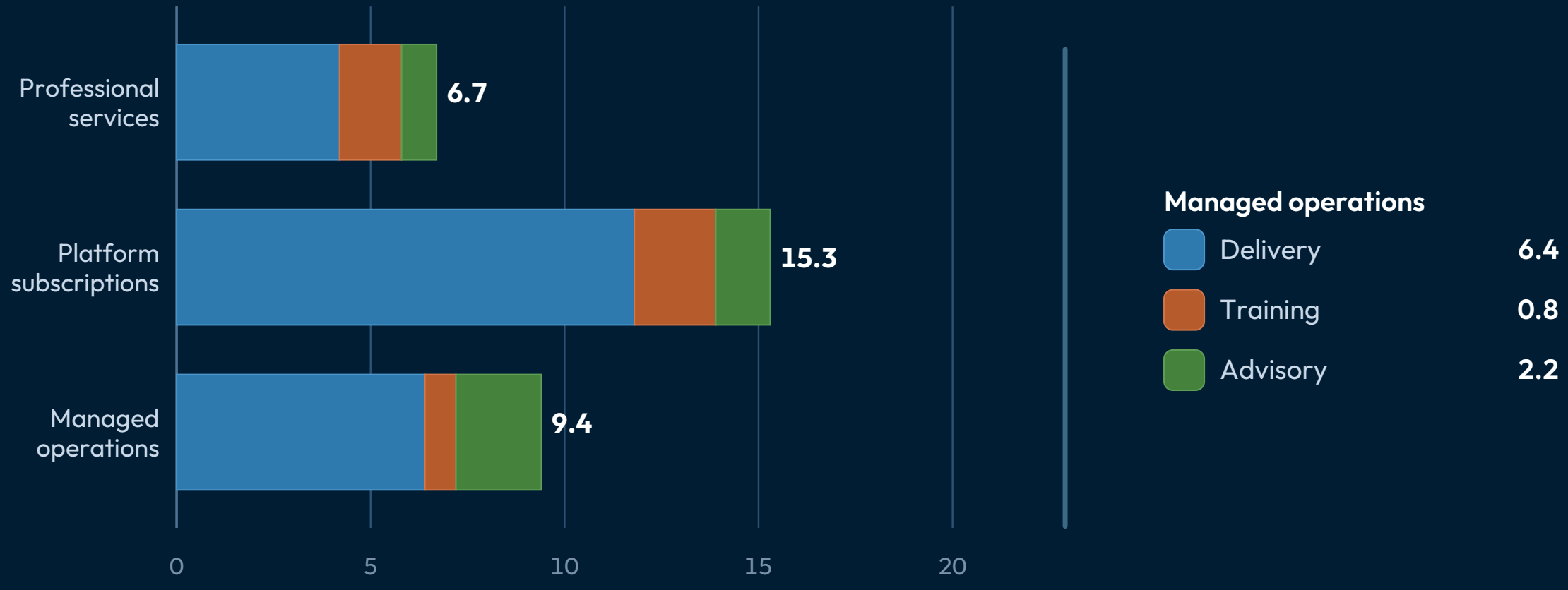
Each bar is a total; the bands inside it are the mix.



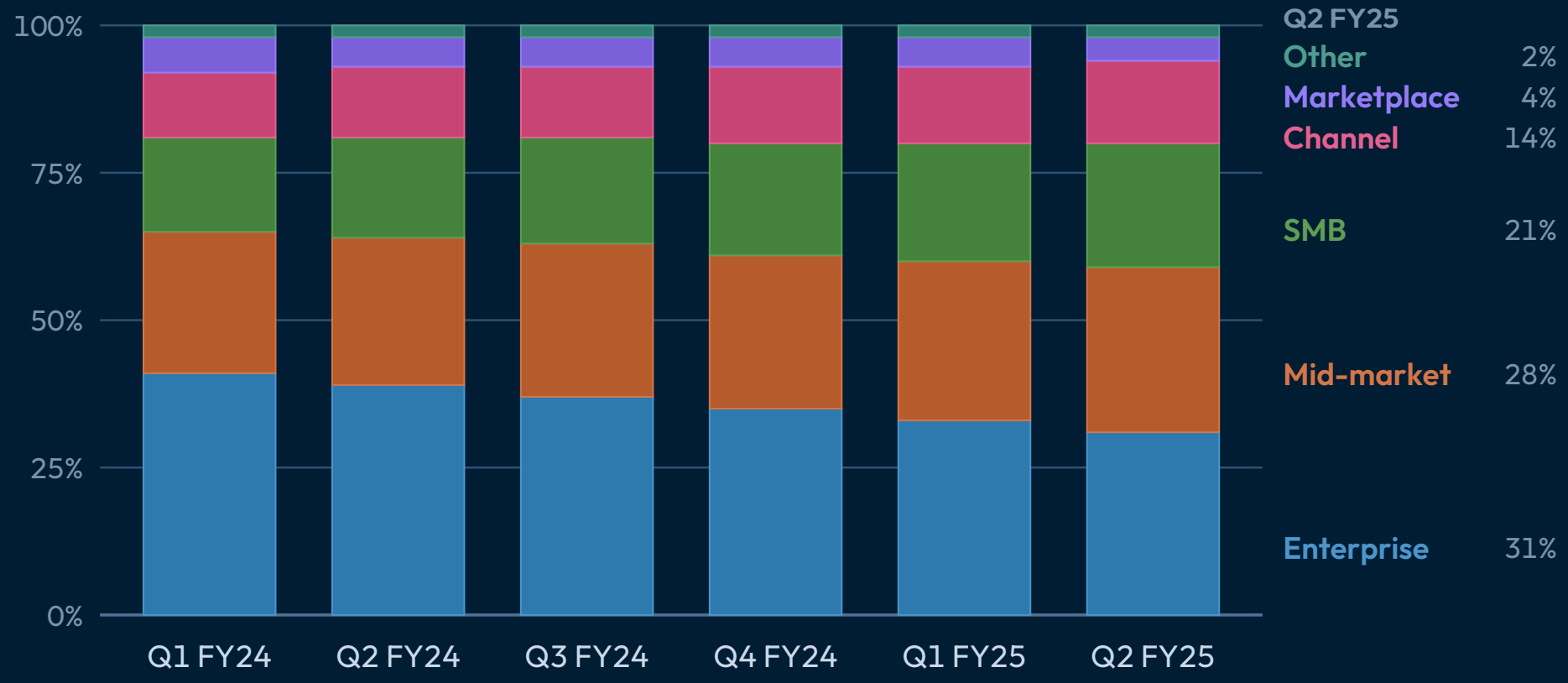
share normalizes every bar, so only the mix is compared.



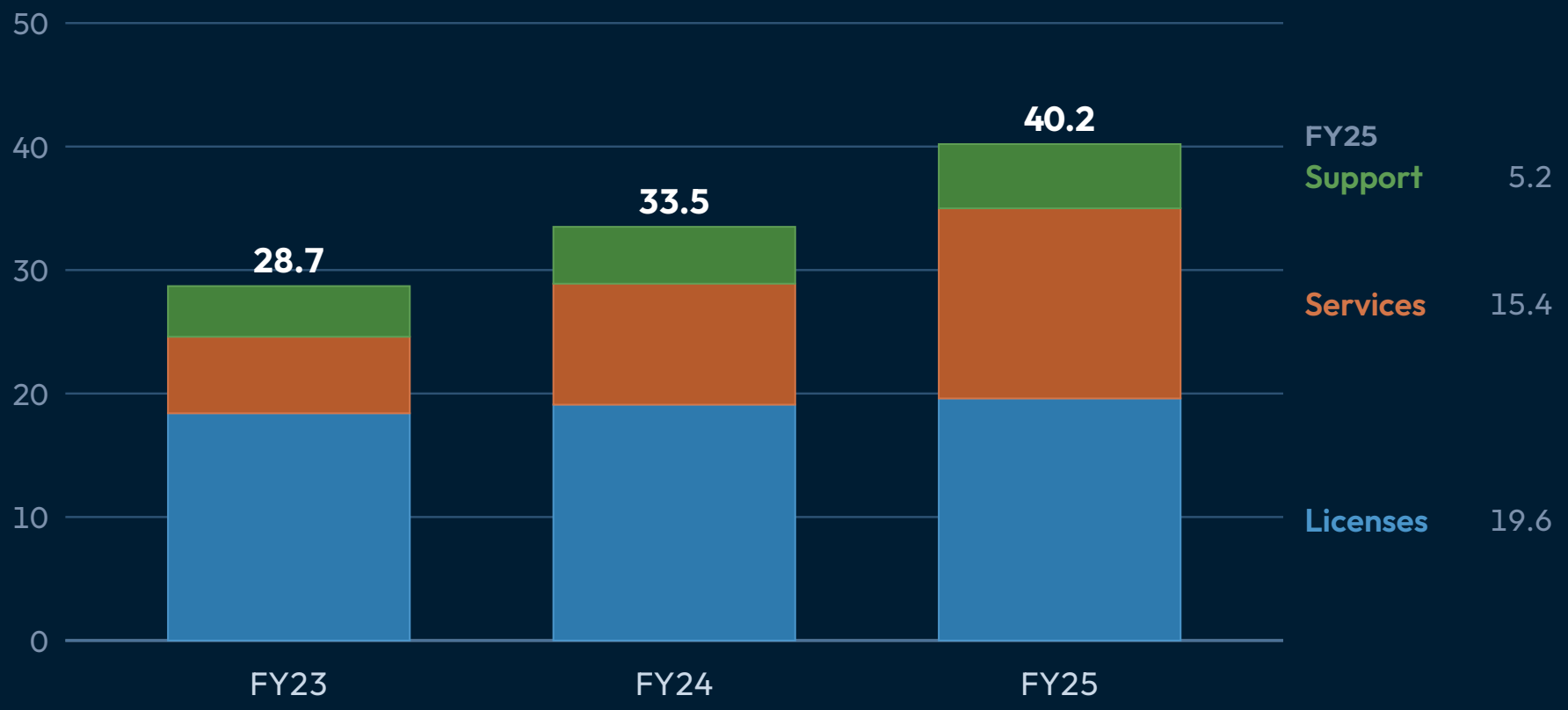
row turns the stack on its side for long category names.



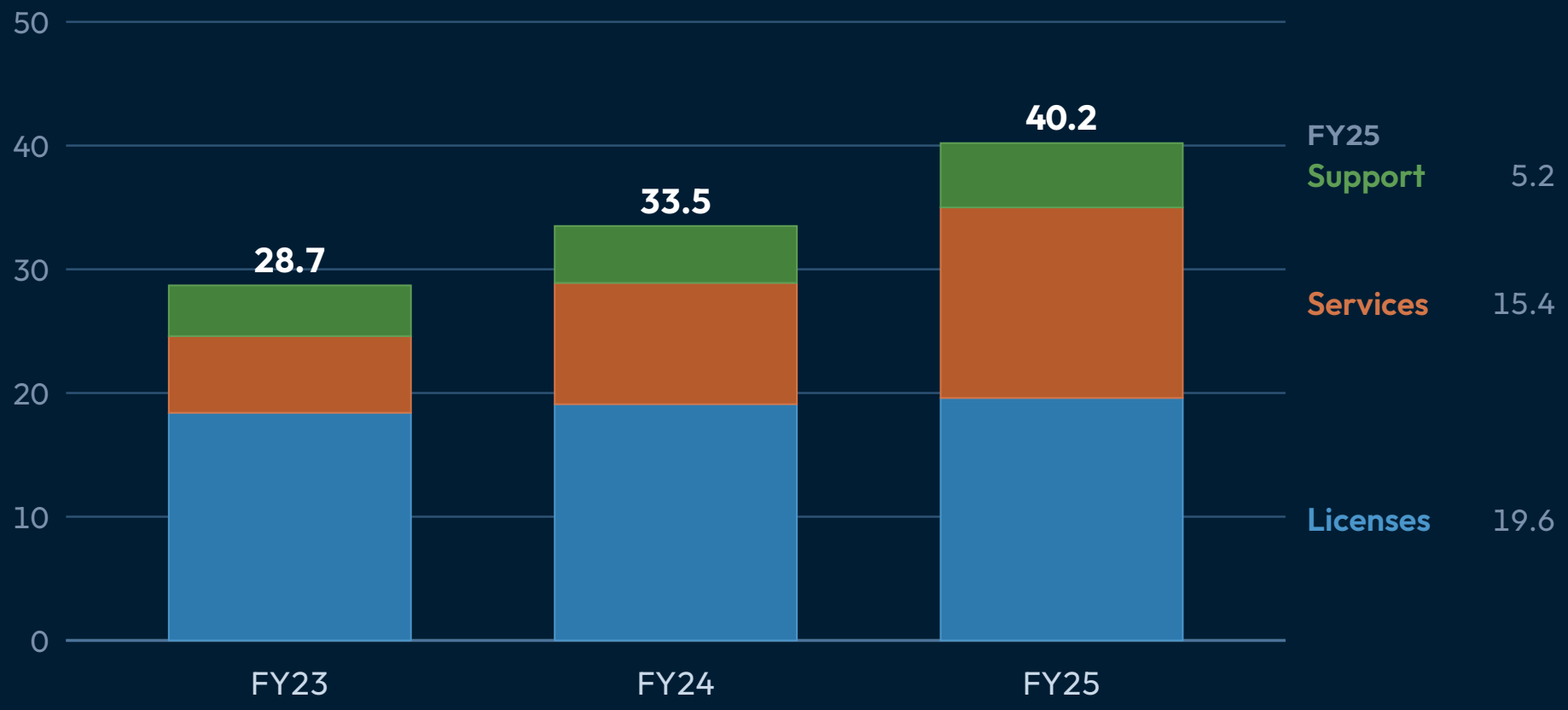
Six parts, six periods, one sliver that should have been folded in.



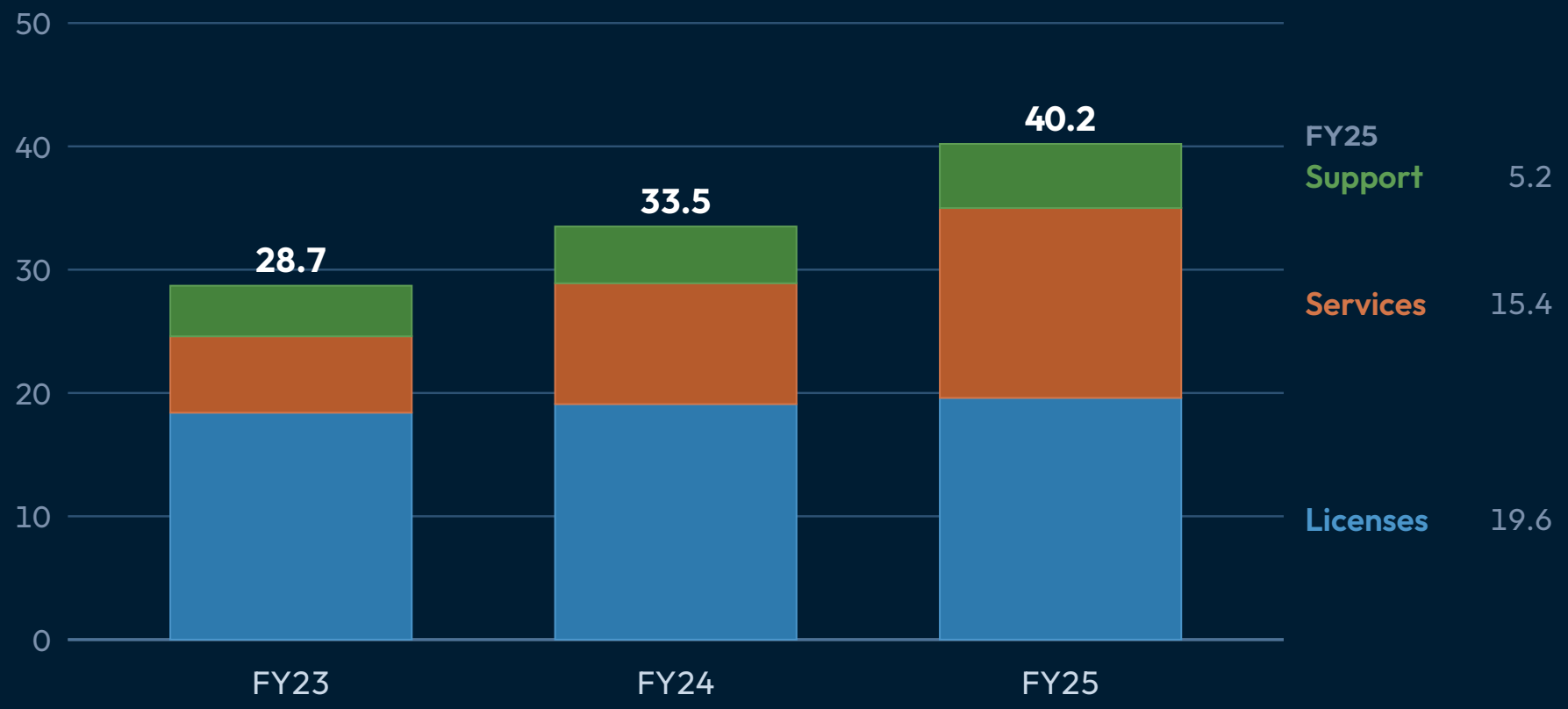
Each bar is a total; the bands inside it are the mix.



Each bar is a total; the bands inside it are the mix.



Each bar is a total; the bands inside it are the mix.



When NOT to reach for stacked-bar.

Tracking a part that is not at the bottom

Only the bottom segment shares a baseline, so a reader sees where 'Services' sits, not whether it grew. Put that part first.

Parts that are not parts

Stacking revenue, headcount and NPS gives a bar whose height means nothing. The parts must sum to something a reader can name.

When NOT to reach for stacked-bar.

A long tail of slivers

A 2 % part is one unit of bar height: too thin to see and impossible to label. Consolidate the tail into one 'Other' part.

One category

A single stacked bar is a pie drawn as a column, and a pie reads proportions better. This chart earns its shape ACROSS bars.

Related components

See also.

`piechart` — one total to decompose, with no comparison across categories

`progress` — independent attainment bars with no parts and no shared value axis

`funnel` — the stages are a narrowing pipeline, not parts of a total

`matrix-grid` — the cells are qualitative judgments rather than values that sum